More features in OpenDocViewer

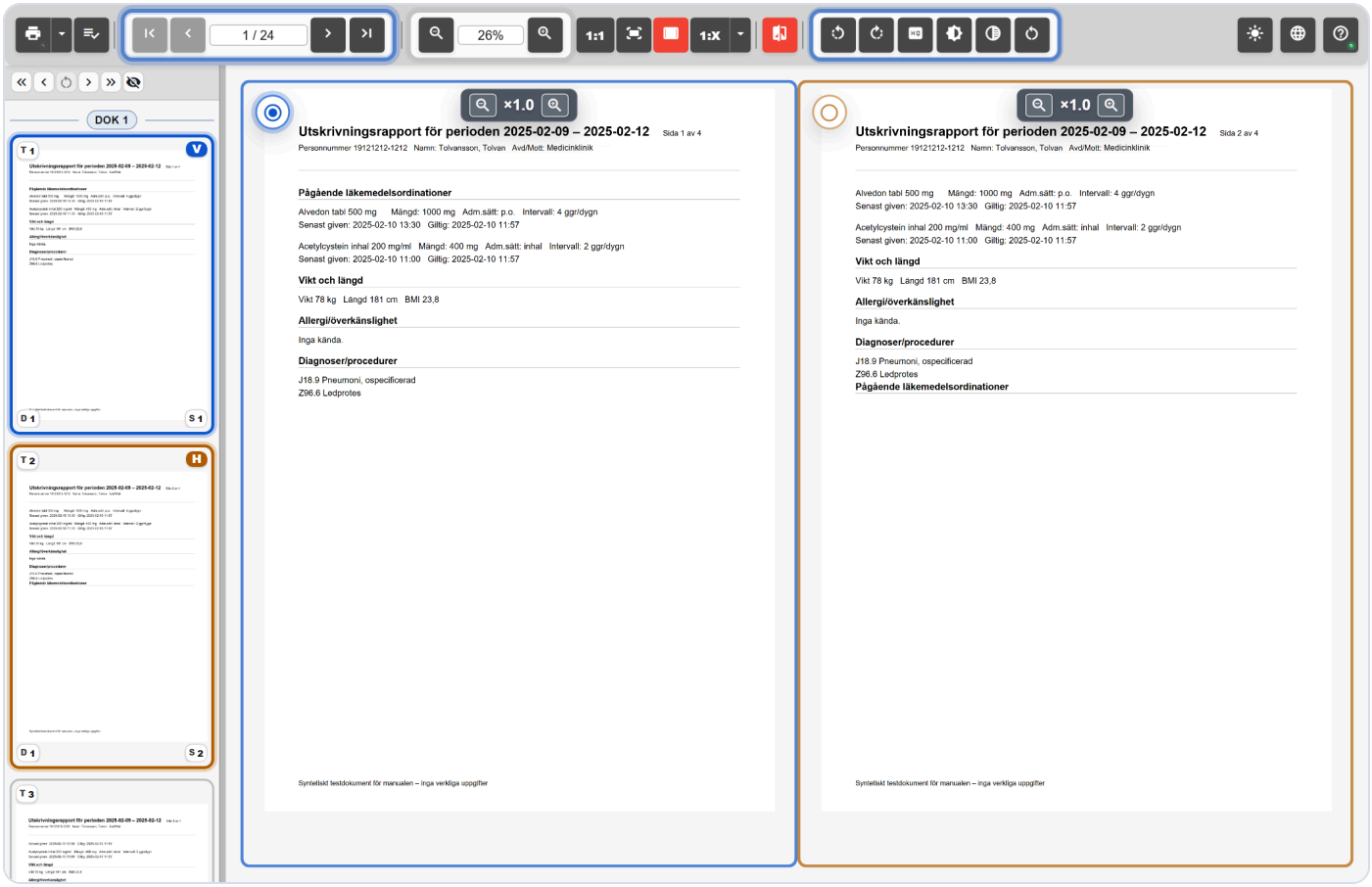
This continues the Getting started guide: features that not everyone needs every day, but that are good to know about. Read the section you need.

The pictures show a made-up test document, in the Swedish interface; the button names here are the English ones. Download the guide as PDF.

- Compare two pages
- Document metadata
- Sharper PDF pages
- Custom size and default zoom
- All keyboard shortcuts
- The toolbar button by button
- Dark theme
- Support information

Compare two pages

Click the **compare button** in the toolbar (*Enable compare mode*). The page you are looking at moves to the left with a **blue frame**, and a second page is shown on the right with an **orange frame**. To swap the right-hand page: right-click a thumbnail and choose *Show to right*.



Compare mode. Each page has its own zoom buttons along the top. In the pane, the left page is marked **V** and the right page **H** (Swedish for left and right).

One of the pages is always **active** – the one you last clicked in. The toolbar and the keyboard control the active page, and the frames around the buttons show which one: blue for left, orange for right.

If you print with the **Active page** method while comparing, you can choose to include only the active page or *Both compare pages*. The pages are printed exactly as you see them – rotation, brightness and contrast are included, just as when you look at a single page. With every other print method, the pages are printed as they are in the archive.

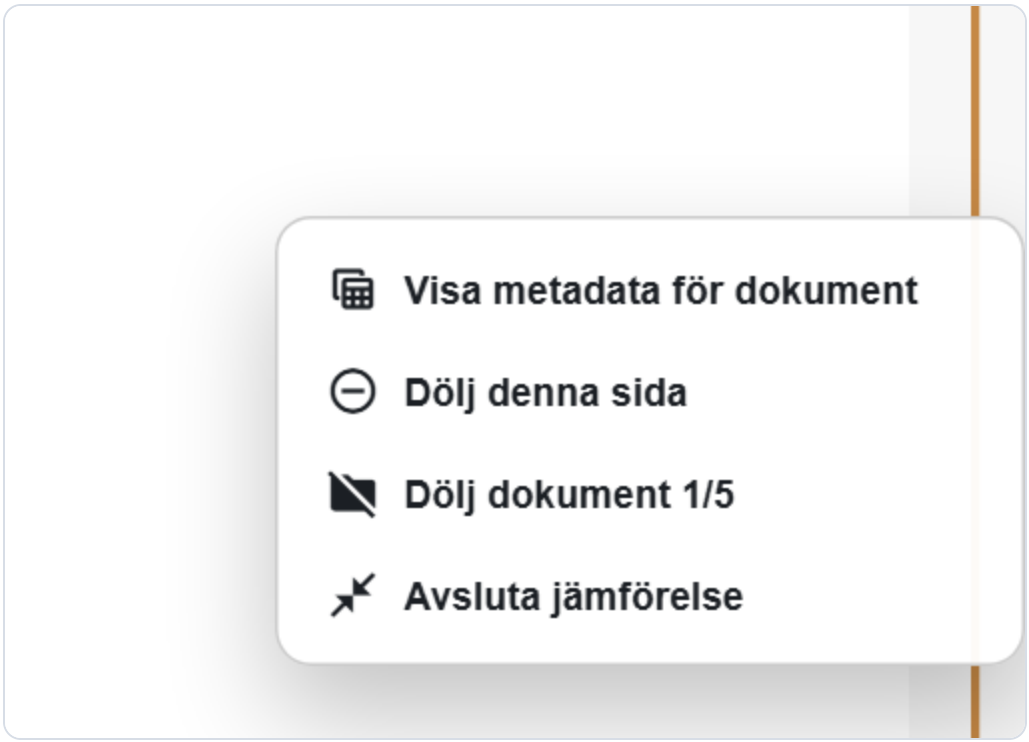
▾ Controlling the other page without switching

Hold `Shift` while you click a button or use the keyboard, and the command applies to the page that is *not* active. The frames change colour while you hold Shift, so you can see what will happen.



Shift held down. Orange frames = the buttons control the right page right now.

`Arrow Left` and `Arrow Right` switch the active page. `Arrow Left` when the left page is already active ends the comparison – so does the compare button, or *Close comparison* in the right-click menu on the right-hand page.



Right-clicking the right page. The usual options, plus *Close comparison*.

Fine-tune zoom, position and rotation

In compare mode, each page has a **Fine-tune** bar above it. Collapsed, the bar shows a summary, for example *100.0 % · 0.0°*. Click it to show the controls for that page:

- **Zoom** in percent with one decimal. The − and + buttons change it by 0.1 % (with `Shift`: 1 %). The zoom buttons along the top of the page still step by 10 % and keep the fine adjustment.
- **Position**: X and Y in pixels. Drag the page with the mouse, or select the move button (four arrows) and use the arrow keys: 1 px per press, 10 px with `Shift`.
- **Rotation** in degrees with one decimal. The ↺ and ↻ buttons turn the page 0.1° (with `Shift`: 1°). A small counter-clockwise tilt shows as a negative number, for example −0.3. The 90° buttons in the toolbar work as before and keep the fine rotation.
- **Reset** (circular arrow) returns the page to 100 %, position 0 and rotation 0.

You can type into the fields with a decimal comma or a decimal point – 12,5 and 12.5 both work. `Enter`, or leaving the field, applies the value. `Esc` undoes what you typed, and `Arrow Up` / `Arrow Down` step the value (with `Shift`: ten steps). While the bar is open, dragging the page moves it instead of scrolling, and `Ctrl` + mouse wheel over the page zooms only that page, 1 % per notch. Close the bar to scroll and zoom as usual again.

Lay the pages on top of each other (overlay)

Small differences are easiest to see when the pages lie on top of each other. Click the **overlay button** (stacked layers) next to the compare button – it is only there while two pages are compared. The overlay view fills the window and has its own toolbar. Page A (the left page, blue) lies underneath and page B (the right page, orange) on top. Both keep the zoom, position and rotation you set in the compare view.

- **Opacity**: the slider sets how visible the top page is, from 0 % (invisible) to 100 % (fully opaque). It starts at 50 %. With the slider selected, `Arrow Left` / `Arrow Right` change it by 1 %, with `Shift` by 10 %, and `Home` / `End` go to 0 % and 100 %.
- **Swap** (up and down arrows) puts the other page on top. The slider always controls the page on top.
- **Calibrate**: the same fine-tune bars as in the compare view, marked A and B, are shown above the pages. Dragging the pages moves the top page, and `Ctrl` + mouse wheel zooms the top page.
- **Nudge mode** (the move button): while it is on, the arrow keys move the top page 1 px (with `Shift`: 10 px). Click the pages first so that the keys go there.

- **Reset to compare** (clock with an arrow) restores the zoom, position and rotation the pages had when you opened the overlay view.
- **Copy calibration** copies the settings of both pages as text (JSON), so you can paste them into a support case.
- **Curtain** opens the curtain view with the same calibration, see the next section.
- **Close** – or `Esc` – takes you back to the compare view. The calibration is kept: the pages keep their adjustments, and the next time you open the overlay view the opacity and the top page are as you left them.

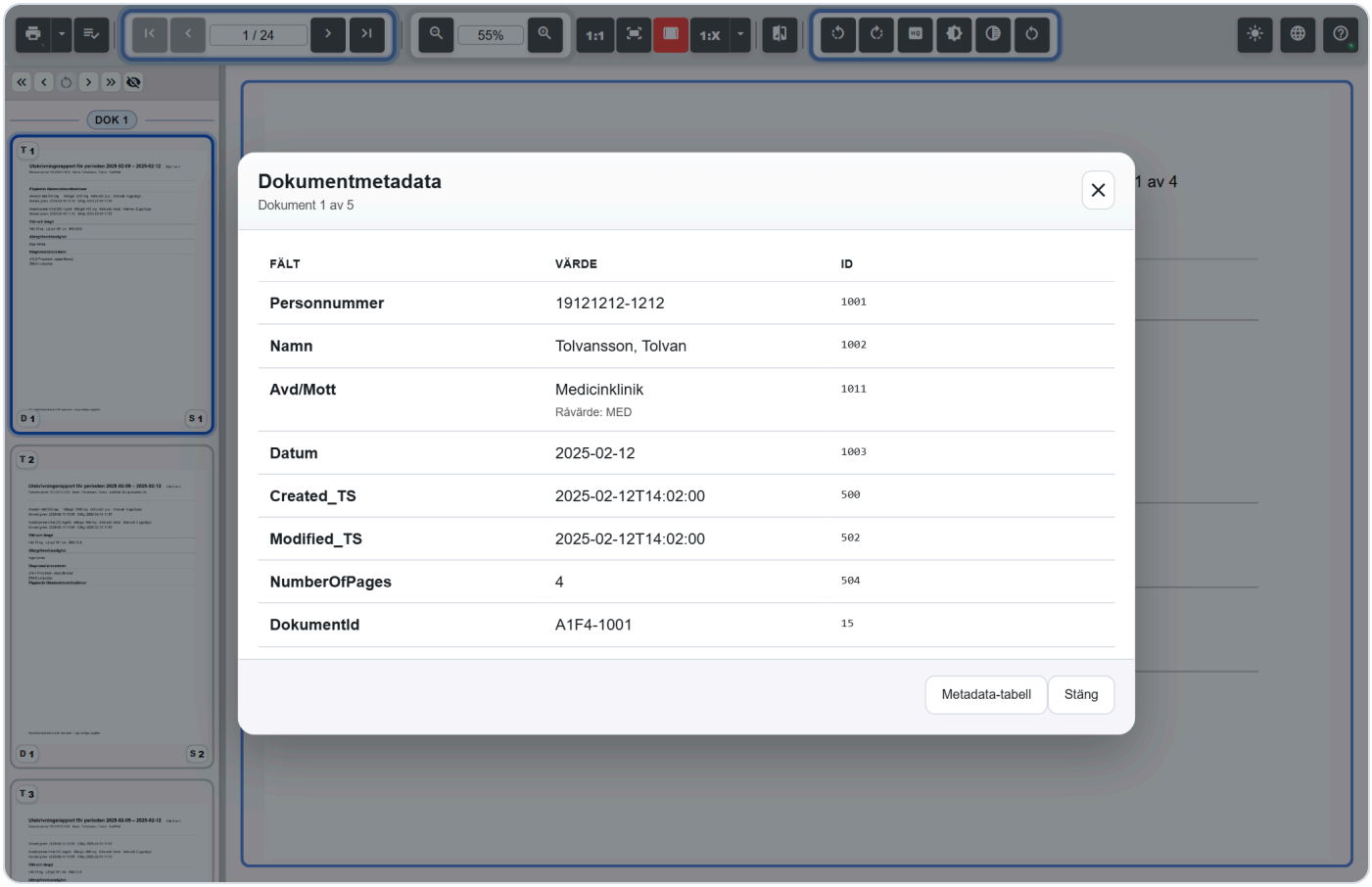
Drag a border between the pages (curtain)

In the curtain view the two calibrated pages lie in the same place, and a border you drag decides where you see which page: page A on one side of the border and page B on the other. This shows quickly whether lines and text continue unbroken across the border.

- **Open**: click **Curtain** in the overlay view's toolbar. In the compare view the curtain button sits next to the overlay button. It can only be used once you have opened the overlay view, which calibrates the pages – until then it is grey, and its tooltip explains why.
- **Horizontal / Vertical** chooses the direction of the border. Vertical: the border is upright, page A shows on the left and page B on the right. Horizontal: the border is level, page A shows above and page B below. The labels in the corners show which page, with its page number, is where.
- **Move the border**: drag the grip on the border with the mouse or a finger. The border is selected when the view opens, so the `arrow keys` move it at once: 1 % per press, 10 % with `Shift`. Each direction remembers its own position while the view is open.
- **Close** – or `Esc` – takes you back to where you opened the curtain view: the overlay view or the compare view. The curtain view never changes the calibration.

Document metadata

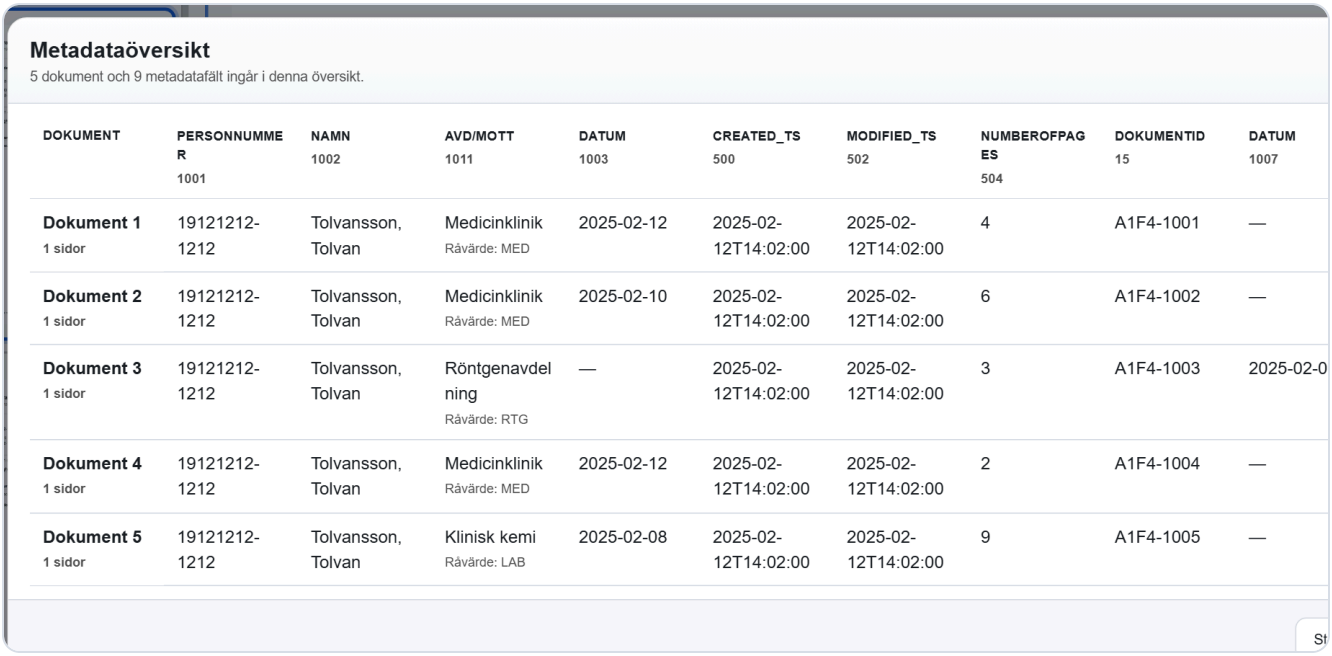
Right-click a thumbnail or the page and choose **Show document metadata**. You see the information the system that opened ODV sent with the document – for example ID, name, department, date, number of pages and document ID. Which fields exist depends on that system. The information is for display only and cannot be changed in ODV.



Document metadata for one document.

▾ All documents in one table

The *Metadata table* button in the metadata dialog shows the whole session as a table – one document per row. Handy when you want to see at a glance which departments and dates are included.



Metadataöversikt

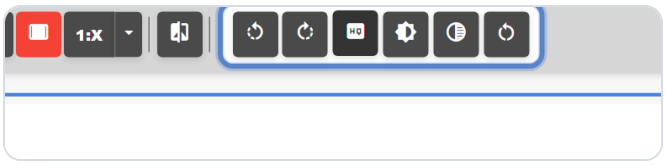
5 dokument och 9 metadatafält ingår i denna översikt.

DOKUMENT	PERSONNUMMER 1001	NAMN 1002	AVD/MOTT 1011	DATUM 1003	CREATED_TS 500	MODIFIED_TS 502	NUMBEROFPAGES 504	DOKUMENTID 15	DATUM 1007
Dokument 1 1 sidor	19121212-1212	Tolvansson, Tolvan	Medicinklinik Råvärde: MED	2025-02-12	2025-02-12T14:02:00	2025-02-12T14:02:00	4	A1F4-1001	—
Dokument 2 1 sidor	19121212-1212	Tolvansson, Tolvan	Medicinklinik Råvärde: MED	2025-02-10	2025-02-12T14:02:00	2025-02-12T14:02:00	6	A1F4-1002	—
Dokument 3 1 sidor	19121212-1212	Tolvansson, Tolvan	Röntgenavdelning Råvärde: RTG	—	2025-02-12T14:02:00	2025-02-12T14:02:00	3	A1F4-1003	2025-02-0
Dokument 4 1 sidor	19121212-1212	Tolvansson, Tolvan	Medicinklinik Råvärde: MED	2025-02-12	2025-02-12T14:02:00	2025-02-12T14:02:00	2	A1F4-1004	—
Dokument 5 1 sidor	19121212-1212	Tolvansson, Tolvan	Klinisk kemi Råvärde: LAB	2025-02-08	2025-02-12T14:02:00	2025-02-12T14:02:00	9	A1F4-1005	—

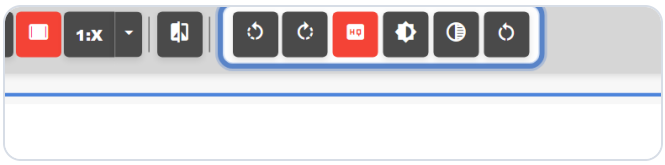
Document metadata overview.

Sharper PDF pages

PDF pages are already shown in print quality. If you need to see a detail even more sharply: click **HQ** in the toolbar (*Increase PDF page resolution*). The page is redrawn at double resolution and the button turns red. It applies only to that page.



Before.

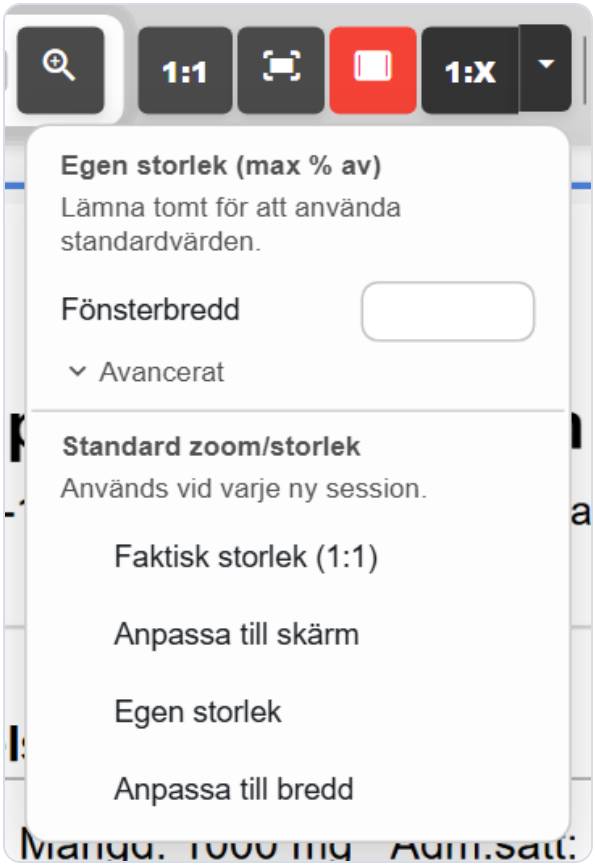


After. Red = the sharpness has been increased.

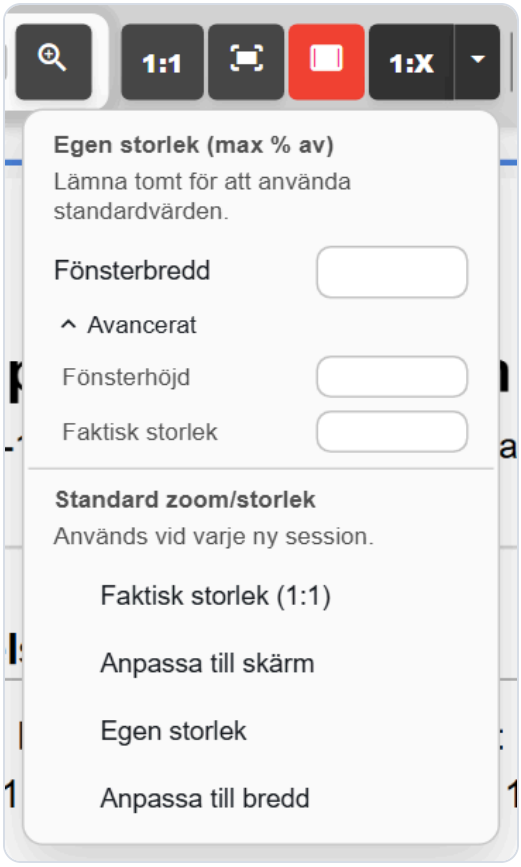
HQ is grey for scanned pages (TIFF/JPEG), because they are already shown exactly as sharp as they were scanned. Hover over the button to see why.

Custom size and default zoom

The **1:X** button (*Custom size*) shows the page at a size you choose yourself – a share of the window width. The arrow next to it opens the settings. There you also choose which zoom every new session should start with (*Default zoom/size*); your organization decides the default. ODV remembers your choices.



Custom size. Share of the window width and default zoom.



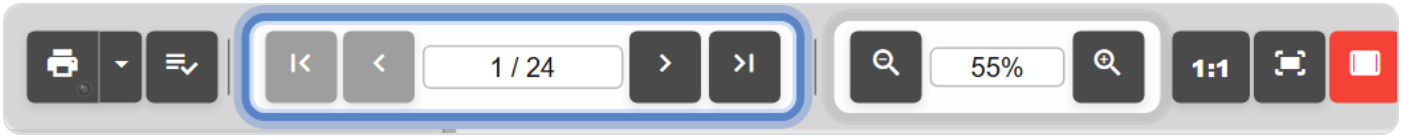
Advanced. Limits for window height and actual size.

All keyboard shortcuts

Key	Does this
`Arrow Up` / `Arrow Down`, `Page Up` / `Page Down`	Previous or next page. Hold down to browse quickly.
`Home` / `End`	First or last page.

Key	Does this
`Ctrl` + any of the above	The same, but document by document instead of page by page.
`+` / `-`	Zoom in or out.
`Ctrl` + `Arrow Left` / `Arrow Right`	Rotate the page.
`Arrow Left` / `Arrow Right`	In compare mode: switch the active page. Arrow Left when the left page is already active ends the comparison.
`Shift` + command	In compare mode: control the page that is not active.
`Delete` / `Ctrl` + `Delete`	Hide the page / hide the whole document (selection).
`Ctrl` + `P`	Open ODV's print dialog.
`Arrow Left` / `Arrow Right` on the opacity slider	In the overlay view: change the opacity by 1 % (with Shift: 10 %).
Arrow keys in nudge mode	In the overlay view: move the top page 1 px (with Shift: 10 px).
`Esc`	Close menus, dialogs and the preview. Also closes the overlay view.

The toolbar button by button



Left: print with an arrow for the default, selection, page navigation, zoom out/in with a percentage box, 1:1, fit to screen, fit to width.

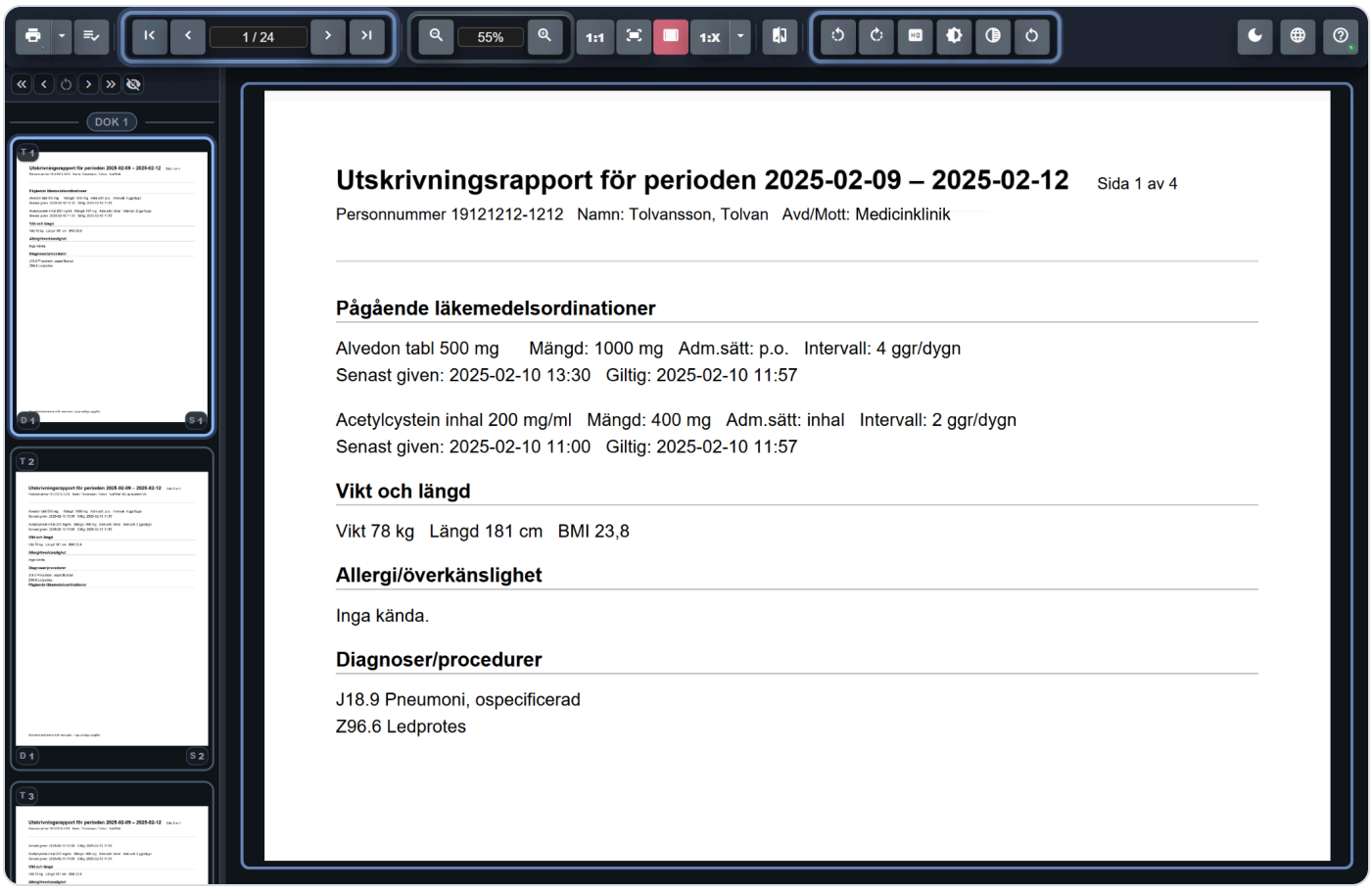


Right: 1:X custom size with an arrow, compare, rotate left/right, HQ, brightness, contrast, reset, and theme, language and help.

- **Print** opens printing. The arrow next to it sets the default, *Active page* or *All pages*.
- **Selection** opens the selection workspace. Red when a selection is active.
- **Page navigation**: first, previous, next, last, and a box for the page number.
- **Zoom**: out, in, percentage box, 1:1, fit to screen, fit to width.
- **1:X**: custom size. **Compare**: two pages side by side. **Overlay**: only in compare mode – lays the pages on top of each other. **Rotate**: a quarter turn.
- **HQ**: sharper PDF page. **Brightness**, **contrast** and **reset**.
- **Theme**, **language**, **help**. The light on the help button: green = all is well, yellow = the computer is low on memory, red = error.

Dark theme

The theme menu at the far right has *Normal*, *Light* and *Dark*. In the dark theme the interface turns dark while the document page is shown as usual.



Dark theme.

Support information

Turn to **your local support** first – they know how ODV is installed and set up in your organization, and can pass the case on to the supplier. Two things make it much easier to help you: the **version** and the **diagnostics file**. Both are under the help menu → *About OpenDocViewer*.

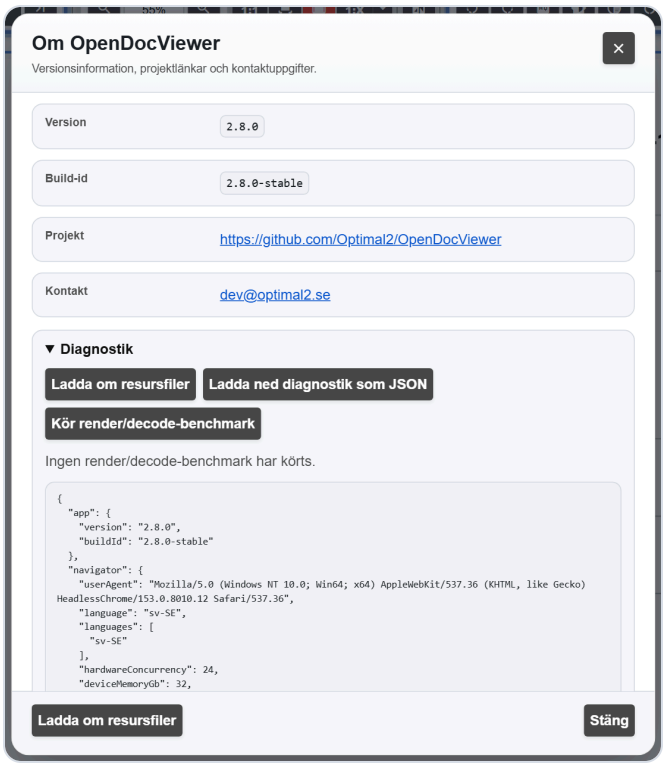
Good to include in the ticket:

- **Version and build ID** from *About OpenDocViewer*.
- **The diagnostics file** (*Download diagnostics JSON*). It contains technical information about ODV and the browser – no documents.
- **When** it happened (date and time), **what you did** and which **browser** you used.
- The text under *Technical details* if an error box was shown.

> **Do not send personal data.** Do not attach screenshots or printouts that show real documents, names or ID numbers, unless your organization has explicitly asked for them.



About OpenDocViewer. Version, build ID and contact details. *Reload resource files* fetches translations and settings again without restarting.



Diagnostics. *Download diagnostics JSON* gives you a file to attach to the ticket. It contains technical information – no documents.

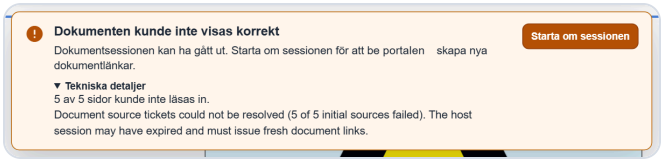
▼ When the session has expired

The box *The documents could not be shown correctly* has a *Technical details* link.

Expand it to see which pages could not be fetched and why. Include that in the ticket.



Expired session.



Technical details.

Back to Getting started with OpenDocViewer. This guide covers OpenDocViewer 2.8.

Updated 2026-09-26.